

Qroo Paul's Spanish Master Course

Lesson 5 Summary

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Hey everybody, Qroo Paul here! Welcome to lesson five in my Spanish Master Series. Today, we're taking another big step forward by learning how to express obligation in Spanish, using the powerful mega verb "tener" (to have). You've already come a long way in a short time, especially if you're an absolute beginner. Let's recap what you've learned so far and build on that foundation.

What You've Learned So Far:

- **Expressing Desire:**
 - *Quiero* (I want)
 - *Quieres* (You want)
 - Example: "¿Quieres estudiar español conmigo mañana?" (Do you want to study Spanish with me tomorrow?)
- **Expressing Ability:**
 - *Puedo* (I can)
 - *Puedes* (You can)
 - Example: "¿Puedo ir al baño?" (Can I go to the bathroom?)
 - These verbs are also used to ask for permission, simply by changing the statement into a question. For example: "¿Puedo?" (Can I?) or "¿Puedes?" (Can you?).

Introducing Obligation with "Tener que":

Now that you can express what you want and what you can do, it's time to learn how to express what you have to do—obligation. The mega verb for today is "**tener**" (to have). This verb is a bit irregular, but don't worry, we'll focus on just the first and second person forms, just like we've been doing.

Key Conjugations:

- **Tengo** (I have)
- **Tienes** (You have)

Key Construction:

- **"Tener que" + infinitive** is used to express obligation.
 - Example: "Tengo que trabajar mañana." (I have to work tomorrow.)
 - Example: "Tienes que confirmar la reservación." (You have to confirm the reservation.)

Understanding "que" in "tener que":

You might be tempted to translate the word "que" directly as "what" or "that," but in this context, it doesn't translate directly into English. Instead, think of "tener que" as a set formula. The "que" is simply a part of the structure that you need to remember. For example:

- "Tengo que verificar la información." (I have to verify the information.)
- "¿Tienes que trabajar el miércoles?" (Do you have to work on Wednesday?)

Using "Tener" with Indefinite Articles:

Remember to match the indefinite article (un, una) with the noun it accompanies. For instance:

- "¿Tienes un libro?" (Do you have a book?)
- "Sí, tengo un libro." (Yes, I have a book.)
- "¿Tienes una computadora?" (Do you have a computer?)

Depending on where you are, the word for computer might change:

- "¿Tienes un ordenador?" (in Spain)
- "¿Tienes un computador?" (in Colombia)

Using Definite Articles with Days of the Week:

When talking about obligations on specific days, Spanish often uses definite articles (el, la) with days of the week:

- "Tengo que trabajar el lunes." (I have to work on Monday.)
- "¿Tienes que trabajar el miércoles?" (Do you have to work on Wednesday?)

One of the few times you won't use a definite article with days of the week is when it follows the verb "ser" (to be), as in "Hoy es lunes" (Today is Monday).

Putting It All Together:

By the end of this lesson, you'll be able to express:

- **Desire:** "Quiero estudiar español." (I want to study Spanish.)
- **Ability:** "Puedo estudiar español." (I can study Spanish.)
- **Obligation:** "Tengo que estudiar español." (I have to study Spanish.)

Example Dialogue:

- **Question:** "¿Quieres estudiar español conmigo mañana?" (Do you want to study Spanish with me tomorrow?)
- **Response:** "Quiero, pero no puedo. Tengo que trabajar." (I want to, but I can't. I have to work.)

Practice and Self-Dialogue:

As always, I encourage you to practice these patterns as much as possible. If you don't have a study buddy, remember, you can always practice with yourself. Ask yourself questions like, "¿Qué tienes que hacer hoy?" (What do you have to do today?) and answer, "Tengo que trabajar." (I have to work.)

Thank you for joining me in this lesson, and I look forward to seeing you in the next one.
¡Hasta luego!